

Su-un Lee

PhD Candidate at The University of Chicago

Email: suun@uchicago.edu

5607 Drexel Ave, Chicago, IL, 60637

Last updated: June 9, 2026

Education

Ph.D. in Quantum Science and Engineering

Sep 2022 – Present

University of Chicago, Chicago, IL

Advisor: [Prof. Liang Jiang](#)

Anticipated graduation: 06/27

B.S. in Physics & B.S. in Mathematical Sciences

Mar 2016 – Aug 2022*

Seoul National University, Seoul, South Korea

Summa Cum Laude

* Military service [Mar. 2019 – Oct. 2020].

Work Experience

Returning Intern: Research Scientist (Scheduled)

Jun 2026 – Sep 2026

IBM Research, Chicago, IL

Mentor: [Kunal Sharma](#).

Quantum Computing Theory Research Scientist Intern

Jun 2025 – Sep 2025

IBM Thomas J. Watson Research Center, Yorktown Heights, NY

Mentors: [Kunal Sharma](#), [Abhinav Deshpande](#), and [Kevin Smith](#).

Featured in [Engineering the summer: Advancing quantum computing at IBM](#)

Research Highlights

Opportunities and Limitations of Near-term Quantum Computers

- *Classical (in)tractability of quantum advantage experiments*: Identified the limitations of classical methods for several quantum advantage experiments, including advanced Pauli propagation and tensor network simulation.
- *Simulating dissipation with noisy ancilla*: Proposed a method to realize dissipative quantum dynamics with noisy ancilla qubits.

Information Processing and Complexity in Random Quantum Circuits

- *Classical simulation of random circuits*: Developed classical simulation methods for random circuits with generic noise, or noiseless shallow-depth random circuits.
- *Information processing in noisy random circuits*: Discovered a universal information spreading behavior that is intrinsic to noisy random circuits.

Benchmarking Near-term and Early Fault-tolerant Quantum Devices

- *Benchmarking logical quantum information processing*: Developed benchmarking methods for logical states and logical Pauli channels.
- *Benchmarking dynamical quantum circuits*: Developed methods for benchmarking quantum circuits with mid-circuit measurements and reset channels.

Undergraduate Research Program, Seoul National University

2020 – 2022

- Quantum information scrambling in continuous-variable systems: Advised by [Prof. Hyun-seok Jeong](#) and [Prof. Hyukjoon Kwon](#).
- Deep learning for dark-matter-only cosmological evolution: Advised by [Prof. Ji-hoon Kim](#) and [Prof. Myungjoo Kang](#).

Technical Skills & Experience

Classical Simulation of Quantum Systems / Quantum Circuits

- Developed a pipeline for Projected Entangled Pair States (PEPS) and Belief-Propagation (BP) simulations (being actively used in multiple projects in IBM Quantum).
- Implemented MPS/MPO simulation from scratch using only NumPy functions ([GitHub repository](#)).
- Large-scale stabilizer simulation for pure and mixed states.

Machine Learning and Deep Learning

- Construct and train deep neural networks with PyTorch and TensorFlow, accelerated with Multi-GPU programming.
- Developed automatic hyperparameter optimization routines with Optuna.

High-Performance Computing (HPC)

- Cloud computing and multi-GPU programming supported by NVIDIA Academic Grant Program.
- Midway, Research Computing Center, University of Chicago
- [Nuiron](#) & [Neuron](#), Korea Institute of Science and Technology Information

Programming

- Programming languages: Python, Julia, etc.
- Version control: Git and GitHub

Awards & Honors

- **Kwanjeong Educational Foundation Scholarship**

2022 – 2027

- **Eminence Scholarship**, Seoul National University

2016, 2018, 2019

Publications

In reverse chronological order. See also [Google Scholar](#)

- [1] Chia-Tung Chu, **SL**, Han Zheng, Senrui Chen, Bibek Pokharel, Alireza Seif, and Liang Jiang, Learning Mid-circuit Measurement Backaction from Three Repeated Measurements. (2026), arXiv:2606.00433 [quant-ph].
- [2] William Kirby, Bibek Pokharel, Javier Robledo Moreno, Kevin C. Smith, Sergey Bravyi, Abhinav Deshpande, Constantinos Evangelinos, Bryce Fuller, James R. Garrison, Ben Jaderberg, Caleb Johnson, Petar Jurcevic, **SL**, Simon Martiel, Mario Motta, Seetharami Seelam, Oles Shtanko, Kevin J. Sung, Minh Tran, Vinay Tripathi, Kazuhiro Seki, Kazuya Shinjo, Han Xu, Lukas Broers, Tomonori Shirakawa, Seiji Yunoki, Kunal Sharma, and Antonio Mezza-capo, Observation of Improved Accuracy over Classical Sparse Ground-State Solvers using a Quantum Computer. (2026), arXiv:2603.03496
- [3] **SL**^{*}, Ming Yuan^{*}, Senrui Chen, Kento Tsubouchi, and Liang Jiang, Efficient benchmarking of logical magic states *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **136**, 050602 (2026).
- [4] Han Zheng, Chia-Tung Chu, Senrui Chen, Argyris Giannisis Manes, **SL**, Sisi Zhou, and Liang Jiang, Efficient learning of logical noise from syndrome data. (2026), arXiv:2601.22286 [quant-ph].
- [5] **SL**, Soumik Ghosh, Changhun Oh, Kyungjoo Noh, Bill Fefferman, and Liang Jiang, Classical simulation of noisy random circuits from exponential decay of correlation. (2025), arXiv:2510.06328 [quant-ph]. (Submitted to *Phys. Rev. Lett.*).
- [6] Yifan F. Zhang^{*}, **SL**^{*}, Liang Jiang, and Sarang Gopalakrishnan, Classically sampling noisy quantum circuits in quasi-polynomial time under approximate Markovianity (2025), arXiv:2510.06324 [quant-ph].
- [7] **SL**, Changhun Oh, Yat Wong, Senrui Chen, and Liang Jiang, Universal spreading of conditional mutual information in noisy random circuits. *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **133**, 200402 (2024).

^{*} Equal contribution

Presentations

Invited Talks

- IBM Quantum Computing PIC Seminar Series, IBM T. J. Watson Research Center, Yorktown Heights, NY Mar, 2026
- Google Quantum AI Tensor Network Seminar, Google Quantum AI, CA Jan, 2026
- IBM Quantum Computing PIC Seminar Series, IBM T. J. Watson Research Center, Yorktown Heights, NY Oct, 2025
- IBM Quantum Computing PIC Seminar Series, IBM T. J. Watson Research Center, Yorktown Heights, NY Sep, 2025
- Quantum Information Science and Engineering Seminar, University of Chicago, Chicago, IL Dec, 2024

Contributed Talks

- Global Physics Summit 2026, Denver, CO March, 2026
- Korea Quantum Information Science Conference (K-QIS), Seoul, South Korea Nov, 2025
- Global Physics Summit 2025, Anaheim, CA March, 2025
- APS March Meeting 2024, Minneapolis, MN March, 2024

Academic Service

Program Committee

- *2nd Workshop on HPC/AI Integration with Quantum Computing/Networking (HAIQ 2026)*

Journal Referee services

- *Physical Review A* (6 times)
- *PRX Quantum* (2 times)
- *Physical Review Research* (1 time)
- *Physical Review Applied* (2 times)
- *APS Open Science* (1 time)
- *Quantum* (1 time)

Conference Reviewer

- *Theory of Quantum Computation, Communication and Cryptography (TQC 2026)*
- *29th Annual Conference on Quantum Information Processing (QIP 2026)*
- *25th Asian Quantum Information Science Conference (AQIS 2025)*
- *Theory of Quantum Computation, Communication and Cryptography (TQC 2025)*
- *28th Annual Conference on Quantum Information Processing (QIP 2025)*

Teaching Experience

University of Chicago

- Guest Lecturer – Advanced Quantum Information and Computation Winter 2025
- Teaching Assistant – Advanced Quantum Information and Computation Winter 2025
- Teaching Assistant – Intermediate Quantum Engineering Autumn 2023

Seoul National University

- Teaching Assistant – Foundation of Physics 1 Spring 2022
- Teaching Assistant – Foundation of Physics 1 Spring 2021
- Teaching Assistant – Basic Calculus 1 Spring 2018

References

Liang Jiang

Professor of Molecular Engineering
University of Chicago
Email: liang.jiang@uchicago.edu

Bill Fefferman

Associate Professor of Computer Science
University of Chicago
Email: wjf@uchicago.edu

Kunal Sharma

Senior Research Scientist / Team Manager
IBM Research
Email: kunals@ibm.com